

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



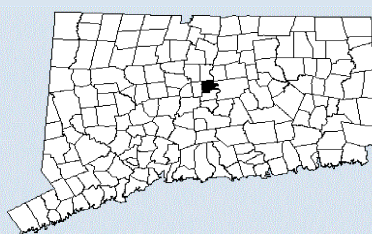
Wethersfield School District

Michael Emmett, Superintendent • 860-571-8110 • <https://wps.wethersfield.me>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	10
Enrollment	3,584
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$18,723
Total Expenditures ¹	\$73,414,503

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	1,800	50.2	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	10	0.3	0.2
Asian	178	5.0	5.2
Black or African American	167	4.7	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	771	21.5	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	7	0.2	0.1
Two or More Races	149	4.2	4.7
White	2,302	64.2	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	374	10.4	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,041	29.0	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	554	15.5	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	47	2.6
Male	124	7.1	132	7.1
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	15	9.1	18	10.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	92	12.1	62	7.6
White	114	5.1	88	3.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	39	10.3	19	4.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	134	14.0	83	7.5
Students with Disabilities	79	15.0	53	8.1
District	248	7.1	179	4.9
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 328

Number of school-based arrests: 7

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Wethersfield School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	233.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	20.3
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	33.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	114.6
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	7.0
School Level	11.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	2.0
Support Staff	8.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	20.6
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	25.0
School Nurses	8.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	202.8

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	5	1.5	1.4
Black or African American	4	1.2	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5	1.5	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	1	0.3	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	317	95.2	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.8	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	10	*	14	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	37	66.1	56	86.2
White	139	72.0	165	92.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	10	*	7	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	48	68.6	54	84.4
Students with Disabilities	29	59.2	40	81.6
District	209	71.1	250	89.0
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	55	56.1
Emotional Disability	16	44.4
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	160	89.9
Other Health Impairment	90	87.4
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	64	100.0
District	397	75.3
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	113	3.0	2.6
Emotional Disability	36	1.0	1.1
Intellectual Disability	27	0.7	0.6
Learning Disability	178	4.8	6.4
Other Health Impairment	105	2.8	3.5
Other Disabilities	32	0.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	79	2.1	2.0
All Disabilities	570	15.2	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	48	8.4	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	26	4.6	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$48,366,069	\$12,335	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$5,254,623	\$1,451	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$1,711,248	\$473	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$567,055	\$157	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$2,673,237	\$738	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$3,674,694	\$1,015	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,956,368	\$1,921	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$3,364,961	\$1,486	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$846,248	\$234	\$213
Total	\$73,414,503	\$18,723	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$3,297,734	20.9	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,935,823	18.6	10.2
Other Salaries	\$441,423	2.8	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,035,185	12.9	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$429,801	2.7	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$4,899,410	31.0	22.2
Supplies	\$59,601	0.4	0.7
Property Services	\$57,000	0.4	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,611,243	10.2	8.4
Equipment	\$26,504	0.2	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$825	0.0	0.1
Total	\$15,794,549	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		21.5	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	74.1
State	21.1
Federal	4.0
Tuition & Other	0.8

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	97	71.0	97	68.7	42	71.0
Black or African American	85	62.5	84	53.7	42	54.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	379	59.4	379	54.0	160	55.4
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	88	70.7	88	65.2	41	69.5
White	1,172	72.1	1,171	67.9	521	70.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	305	58.4	305	55.0	131	53.5
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,523	71.0	1,521	66.1	679	69.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	490	59.7	489	52.9	208	58.7
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,338	72.2	1,337	68.4	602	69.2
Students with Disabilities	255	45.6	253	40.3	113	42.1
Students without Disabilities	1,573	72.6	1,573	68.1	697	70.5
High Needs	754	58.5	752	53.3	335	55.1
Non-High Needs	1,074	76.1	1,074	71.9	475	74.6
District	1,828	68.9	1,826	64.2	810	66.5

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	88.6	83.9	72.3	88.9	1,090	83.2
Curl Up	83.9	79.6	81.9	92.6	1,086	84.4
Push Up	64.2	55.2	79.2	88.6	1,088	71.9
Mile Run/PACER	78.0	68.7	69.6	64.8	1,086	70.2
All Tests - District	44.5	41.0	44.2	57.7	1,077	46.8
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	12	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	65	83.1
White	206	94.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	11	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	105	86.7
Students with Disabilities	50	72.0
District	306	91.2
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	148	55.0
Male	118	38.9
Non-Binary	0	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	34	28.1
White	206	55.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	37	27.6
Students with Disabilities	6	6.1
District	266	46.3
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	88.1	91.9
Male	73.0	92.7
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	70.2	83.3
White	85.1	93.0
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	68.8	85.2
Students with Disabilities	47.5	89.3
District	80.6	92.3
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	68.9	75	45.9	50	91.8	63.9
	High Needs Students	58.5	75	39.0	50	78.0	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	64.2	75	42.8	50	85.7	60.2
	High Needs Students	53.3	75	35.5	50	71.0	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	66.5	75	44.4	50	88.7	61.8
	High Needs Students	55.1	75	36.7	50	73.4	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	57.3%	100%	57.3	100	57.3	58.7%
	High Needs Students	53.7%	100%	53.7	100	53.7	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	63.6%	100%	63.6	100	63.6	61.4%
	High Needs Students	56.0%	100%	56.0	100	56.0	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	69.2%	100%	34.6	50	69.2	58.9%
	Oral	62.0%	100%	31.0	50	62.0	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	7.1%	<=5%	45.8	50	91.7	17.7%
	High Needs Students	12.5%	<=5%	35.0	50	70.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	79.8%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	46.3%	75%	30.8	50	61.7	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		94.9%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		91.2%	94%	97.0	100	97.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		91.7%	94%	97.5	100	97.5	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		80.6%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		96.4% 46.8%	75%	31.2	50	62.4	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		67.2%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1127.9	1450	77.8	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	58.5	16.5	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	71.9	53.3	18.7	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	74.6	55.1	19.6	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	91.7%	2.3%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.1
	High Needs Students	98.4
Math	All Students	98.9
	High Needs Students	98.0
Science	All Students	98.8
	High Needs Students	97.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 54.1

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Wethersfield School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Wethersfield's Board of Education approved a new District Strategic Plan for 2023-2029. It guides the innovative and focused work of district and school improvement efforts. Goals and actions are related to: student achievement; civic and family engagement; and management, operation, and finance. Each year the District Improvement Plan is revised based on feedback from data, surveys and administrators to more clearly define actions for the current year. Wethersfield Public Schools continues to use Parent Square, a communication tool that allows parents to receive all communications in their native language. This has improved communication with our multilingual parents. In addition, the district has increased the use of interpreters as a way to ensure multilingual parents have access to important information to support student success.

Each school has a leadership team that provides ongoing feedback to school administration and critical teacher leadership towards the school and district goals. The leadership team provides support in the development of the individual School Improvement Plan that outlines important strategies related to the three district priorities of: -Empathy - PRIORITY #1: Build a positive, empathetic, and safe community and increase effective communication.

-Achievement - PRIORITY #2: Increase student achievement through implementation of innovative, inclusive instruction and evidence-based practices

-Equity - PRIORITY #3: Deliberately identify inequities in our policies and practices that impact our community, and change structures to ensure equitable outcomes for all, inclusive of race.

One of the data driven areas of focus was attendance. Both district and school based teams regularly tracked their attendance rates, provided positive and informative messages to parents through Parent Square, and had on-going conversations with parents around the importance of good attendance and strategies to improve attendance and tardies to school.

In partnership with the Wethersfield Early Childhood Collaborative (WECC) and the Family and Early Childhood Coordinator parent leadership training through the UConn People Empowering People (PEP) program. Positive District wide messages around attendance, social emotional learning, and restorative practices helps to inform all stakeholders on district wide improvement areas.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Wethersfield Public Schools (WPS) participates in the Open Choice program. The Open Choice Family Liaison has been effective in engaging families from Hartford and supporting their transition through schools.

Wethersfield also celebrates over 40 different languages spoken in its schools and continues to see its population become more ethnically, racially, and religiously diverse. This rich cultural, racial, and linguistic diversity allows staff to celebrate differences and allows students to learn from each other. Wethersfield continues to network and partner with different community groups such as the Public Library, Wethersfield Early Childhood Collaborative, Social and Youth Services, Health District, etc. to engage parents and families and ultimately reduce the racial, ethnic, and economic isolation.

Four years ago, Wethersfield Board of Education and Town Staff created a town-wide Social Justice Coalition (SJC) to engage community members and staff in courageous conversations about race, diversity and equitable outcomes. Wethersfield Public Schools also provides parent leadership training and ensures that parents selected represent the diverse demographics of our community.

The staff BIPOC Affinity group also hosted the first BIPOC Community Fair for students and families of color. Student artwork was displayed, town leaders of color spoke at the event and many BIPOC vendors were present to share their resources. Over 400 people attended to celebrate our students and families of color. A parent BIPOC Affinity group has also started to form and has partnered with the staff affinity group to support and celebrate diversity.

The District Improvement Plan identifies many important focus areas related to the priority of equity including the development and Board of Education approval of a district plan to increase the racial, ethnic and linguistic diversity of the educator workforce. Wethersfield has committed to hiring a diverse workforce that serves as windows, mirrors and sliding glass doors for our students and stakeholders.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The budget design allows the analysis of staffing and funds by school location and program. The analysis of student demographics and student achievement coupled with enrollment and attendance, allows the Board of Education, district administration and staff to ensure an equitable allocation of resources among schools.